

I'll use the same "full family + all established constructions + specialist branches + distinctions + master comparison" standard from the new reference going forward.

Word family: **erode / erodes / eroded / eroding / erosion / erosive / erosional / erodible / erodibility / erosivity**

Base word: erode

Past tense: eroded

Past participle: eroded

** -ing form:** eroding

Major related forms:

- * erosion
- * erosive
- * erosional
- * erodible
- * erodibility
- * erosivity

Useful compounds/extensions:

- * soil erosion
- * coastal erosion
- * shoreline erosion
- * wind erosion
- * water erosion
- * glacial erosion
- * erosion control
- * erosion-resistant
- * dental erosion
- * bone erosion
- * corneal erosion
- * erosive gastritis
- * price erosion
- * margin erosion
- * tax-base erosion
- * architectural/software erosion
- * morphological erosion

Part of speech: verb (動詞)

Related noun/adjectives: erosion (名詞) , erosive / erosional / erodible (形容詞)

Your sentence:

> "A city already under pressure should not normalize behaviour that **erodes everyday

courtesy**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **erodes** means **gradually weakens, damages, or reduces something over time**.

No physical material is being worn away. The writer means that repeated inconsiderate behaviour can gradually make everyday politeness and regard for others weaker.

****繁體中文： ** 逐漸削弱；逐步侵蝕；慢慢破壞某種價值、習慣或社會規範****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “...behaviour that **erodes everyday courtesy**.”

「.....會逐漸**侵蝕日常禮貌與公德意識**的行為。」

Here:

****erode courtesy = 令原本存在的禮貌、體諒和文明習慣逐漸減弱，而不是突然消失****

A. PHYSICAL WEARING AWAY

1. **erode = gradually wear away rock, soil, land, etc. (侵蝕) — 侵蝕；沖蝕；風化侵蝕**

This is the central literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “The river slowly **eroded** the riverbank.”

「河水慢慢**侵蝕**河岸。」

Practice 2

> “Wind and rain have **eroded** the rock.”

「風雨已經**侵蝕**了岩石。」

Practice 3

> “The cliffs are being **eroded** by the sea.”

「懸崖正受到海水**侵蝕**。」

****erode** = 物質因水、風、冰、波浪、摩擦等作用逐漸被磨走、帶走或削減******

2. ****erode** — intransitive = gradually wear away (自動詞) — 被侵蝕 ; 逐漸磨損******

****Erode**** can be transitive or intransitive.

Transitive

> “The waves ****eroded** the cliff******.”

「海浪****侵蝕懸崖****。」

Intransitive

> “The cliff has ****eroded**** badly.”

「懸崖已經嚴重****受到侵蝕 / 被磨損****。」

This dual grammar is important.

3. ****erode away** = gradually disappear through erosion (逐漸侵蝕掉) ******

Practice 4

> “Years of flooding ****eroded away**** much of the riverbank.”

「多年的洪水把大部分河岸逐漸****沖蝕掉****。」

****erode away**** emphasizes eventual disappearance.

It is closely related to bare ****erode****, not a separate core meaning.

B. SOIL / LAND EROSION

4. ****soil erosion** = removal of topsoil (土壤) — 土壤侵蝕******

Practice 5

> “Vegetation helps reduce soil ****erosion****.”

「植被有助減少**土壤侵蝕**。」

Agents include:

- * rainfall
- * runoff
- * rivers
- * wind
- * farming disturbance

soil erosion = 表層土壤被水、風等帶走的過程

5. **water erosion = 水蝕**

Water can remove soil through:

- * raindrop impact
- * surface runoff
- * streams
- * rivers

Common specialist types include:

sheet erosion

大片薄層土壤被均勻沖走；**面蝕**

rill erosion

形成細小沖溝；**細溝侵蝕**

gully erosion

形成較大型沖溝；**溝蝕**

These are specialist subtypes, not separate meanings of **erode**.

6. **wind erosion = 風蝕**

Practice 6

> “Dry farmland is vulnerable to wind **erosion**.”

「乾燥農地容易受到**風蝕**。」

Wind removes and transports exposed soil/sand.

7. **coastal / shoreline erosion = 海岸侵蝕；岸線侵蝕**

Practice 7

> “Storm waves accelerated coastal **erosion**.”

「暴風浪加快了**海岸侵蝕**。」

Common:

- * beach erosion
- * cliff erosion
- * shoreline erosion
- * coastal erosion

8. **riverbank erosion = 河岸侵蝕**

> “Fast-flowing water causes riverbank erosion.”

「快速水流造成**河岸侵蝕**。」

9. **glacial erosion = 冰川侵蝕**

Glaciers can remove and reshape rock as they move.

Common processes discussed in geology include:

- * abrasion
- * plucking

These processes contribute to broader **glacial erosion**.

10. **headward erosion (地貌學) — 溯源侵蝕 / 向源侵蝕**

A stream or gully extends its channel backward toward its source through erosion.

Specialist geomorphology term.

C. **EROSION vs WEATHERING**

This distinction is essential.

weathering

= rock/material breaks down **in place**

erosion

= material is worn away and usually **removed/transported**

Example:

> Frost cracks a rock.

= weathering.

> A river carries the broken pieces away.

= erosion/transport.

In everyday language the distinction may be looser, but geology treats them separately.

D. MATERIAL / ENGINEERING EROSION

11. **erode = wear away a manufactured surface/material (材料) — 磨蝕 ; 侵蝕**

Practice 8

> “Fast-moving particles can **erode** the surface of the pipe.”

「高速移動的粒子可以**磨蝕**管道表面。」

This includes mechanical material loss caused by:

- * particles
- * droplets
- * fluid flow
- * repeated impact

12. **erosion wear = material loss through repeated particle/fluid impact (工程) — 冲蝕磨損**

Common in:

- * turbines
- * pipelines
- * pumps
- * valves
- * aircraft components

This is mechanical/material erosion rather than geographical erosion.

13. **cavitation erosion = 氣蝕 / 空蝕侵蝕**

When vapor bubbles form and collapse rapidly near a solid surface, repeated micro-impacts can damage that surface.

Common in:

- * propellers
- * pumps
- * turbines

This is a specialist engineering type of erosion.

14. **erosion-corrosion = 冲蝕腐蝕**

A combined material-degradation process involving:

- * mechanical erosion; and
- * electrochemical corrosion.

Especially relevant to piping and fluid-handling systems.

It is not identical to either erosion alone or corrosion alone.

E. **ERODE vs CORRODE**

A very important distinction.

erode

usually emphasizes:

> physical/mechanical wearing away or gradual loss.

corrode

usually emphasizes:

> chemical/electrochemical deterioration, especially metals.

Compare:

- > sand erodes a surface
- > salt water corrodes steel

But real engineering systems may experience:

> erosion-corrosion.

F. **ERODE vs ABRADE**

abrade

means wear/scrape a surface through friction.

erode

is broader and may involve:

- * fluid flow
- * weather
- * particles
- * waves
- * gradual figurative weakening

Abrasion can be one mechanism of erosion.

G. FIGURATIVE WEAKENING

15. **erode = gradually weaken or destroy something abstract (比喻) — 逐漸削弱；侵蝕**

This is the **exact passage branch**.

Practice 9 — Original

> “Such behaviour can **erode** everyday courtesy.”

「這類行為會逐漸**侵蝕**日常禮貌。」

Practice 10

> “Repeated dishonesty can **erode** trust.”

「反覆的不誠實行為會逐漸**侵蝕信任**。」

Practice 11

> “Poor communication gradually **eroded** confidence in the project.”

「溝通不良逐漸**削弱了**大家對項目的信心。」

erode = 不是突然摧毀，而是透過長期、重複的小幅損害令某事逐漸變弱

This is one of the most important modern senses.

16. **erode trust = 侵蝕信任**

Very common collocation.

> “Broken promises erode trust.”

= 「失信會逐漸**破壞信任**。」

17. **erode confidence = 削弱信心**

> “Repeated failures eroded investor confidence.”

「接連失敗逐漸**削弱信心**。」

18. **erode support = 使支持逐步下降**

> “The controversy gradually eroded support for the proposal.”

「爭議逐漸令對該建議的**支持減弱**。」

The key idea:

> support declines incrementally.

19. **erode authority / credibility / legitimacy / reputation**

Common figurative objects:

- * authority
- * credibility
- * reputation
- * influence
- * legitimacy
- * status

Example:

> “Repeated contradictions eroded his credibility.”

「前後矛盾的說法逐漸**削弱了他的可信性**。」

20. **erode rights / protections / standards / norms**

The verb can describe gradual weakening of institutional or social safeguards:

- > erode privacy
- > erode protections
- > erode standards
- > erode social norms

Again, the metaphor is:

> solid structure → gradually worn away.

21. **erode a relationship = gradually damage it (關係) **

Practice 12

> “Constant arguments **eroded** their relationship.”

「持續爭吵逐漸**破壞了**他們的關係。」

Not necessarily one dramatic event; typically accumulated damage.

22. **erode morale = 削弱士氣**

> “Months of uncertainty eroded staff morale.”

「數月的不確定性逐漸**削弱員工士氣**。」

23. **erode memory / identity / culture (抽象) **

Literary/social writing may use:

> time eroded the memory

> cultural practices were gradually eroded

> a sense of identity was eroded

Meaning:

> gradually become weaker, less distinct, or less influential.

These remain under the figurative weakening branch.

H. FINANCE / ECONOMICS

24. **erode value = reduce economic value over time (價值) — 侵蝕價值**

Practice 13

> “Inflation can **erode** the value of savings.”

「通脹可以逐漸**侵蝕**儲蓄的價值。」

One of the most common financial collocations.

25. **erode purchasing power** = 削弱購買力

Practice 14

> “Higher prices **erode purchasing power**.”

「價格上升會**削弱**購買力。」

Meaning:

> the same money buys less than before.

26. **price erosion** = prices gradually decline (商業) — 價格下滑 / 價格侵蝕

In business and technology markets, **price erosion** means prices decline progressively over time.

Example:

> “Competition led to rapid price erosion.”

「競爭導致價格迅速**下滑**。」

Notice:

> **erosion of value** = something loses value

> **price erosion** = actual market price falls.

27. **margin erosion** = profit margin gradually narrows (商業) — 利潤率受侵蝕

Practice 15

> “Rising costs caused severe margin **erosion**.”

「成本上升嚴重**侵蝕**了利潤率。」

Common causes include:

- * rising costs
- * discounting
- * competition

This is highly established business language.

28. **profit erosion / earnings erosion (商業) — 盈利下降**

> “Higher labour costs are eroding profits.”

「較高人工成本正在**侵蝕**利潤。」

29. **market-share erosion = market share gradually declines (市場) — 市佔率下滑**

> “The company suffered market-share erosion.”

「公司的**市場佔有率**逐漸下降。」

30. **tax-base erosion = 稅基侵蝕**

A technical taxation/economics term.

It refers broadly to reduction of the income/profit/activity on which tax can effectively be imposed.

Common in:

> base erosion and profit shifting (BEPS)

This is a specialist institutional/economic use of the same metaphor.

31. **capital erosion = reduction in capital value (金融) — 資本被侵蝕**

> “Persistent losses can lead to capital erosion.”

「持續虧損會導致**資本被侵蝕**。」

I. MEDICAL / CLINICAL **EROSION**

Medical English uses **erosion** for relatively superficial loss or damage of tissue/surface.

32. **erosion** = superficial loss of skin or mucosal tissue (醫學) — 糜爛；表淺組織缺損

An **erosion** generally refers to a relatively superficial defect of an epithelial surface.

Exact definitions vary somewhat by specialty.

Examples:

- * skin erosion
- * mucosal erosion
- * gastric erosion

This is a genuine medical noun sense.

33. **skin erosion** = 皮膚糜爛 / 表皮缺損

A superficial loss of epidermal tissue.

Contrast with:

> ulcer

which usually extends deeper.

34. **gastric erosion** = 胃黏膜糜爛

A superficial defect in the stomach lining.

35. **erosive gastritis** = 糜爛性胃炎

The adjective ****erosive**** describes gastritis involving mucosal erosions.

36. ****erosive esophagitis = 糜爛性食道炎****

Inflammatory injury to the esophageal lining with visible erosions.

Specialist clinical term.

37. ****corneal erosion = 角膜糜爛****

Loss/disruption of the corneal epithelium.

A recurrent condition may be called:

> recurrent corneal erosion.

38. ****bone erosion = 骨侵蝕 / 骨質侵蝕****

Used in radiology/rheumatology for localized bone loss/damage, for example near inflamed joints.

39. ****erosive arthritis / erosive osteoarthritis****

Specialist diagnostic terminology describing arthritis associated with characteristic erosive changes.

40. ****cervical erosion — older terminology****

****Cervical erosion**** is an older term historically used for what is now commonly called ****cervical ectropion****.

Important:

> it does ****not necessarily mean the cervix is literally being physically eroded away****.

So this is a terminology trap rather than a straightforward application of the ordinary meaning.

J. DENTISTRY

41. **dental erosion / tooth erosion = chemical loss of tooth substance (牙科) — 牙齒酸蝕 / 牙釉質侵蝕**

A major specialist use.

Practice 16

> “Frequent exposure to acidic drinks can contribute to dental **erosion**.”

「經常接觸酸性飲料可能造成**牙齒酸蝕**。」

Dental erosion typically refers to chemical dissolution of tooth structure by acids **not primarily involving bacterial dental caries**.

42. **enamel erosion = 牙釉質酸蝕**

Loss of enamel through erosive chemical processes.

Important dental distinctions

erosion

chemical dissolution, often acid-related.

abrasion

mechanical wear from an external object/action.

Example:

> aggressive brushing.

attrition

tooth-to-tooth wear.

caries

tooth decay involving bacterial processes.

These are distinct mechanisms even though all can cause loss of tooth structure.

K. PHARMACEUTICAL / DEVICE-RELATED TISSUE EROSION

43. **device erosion = medical device gradually damages/penetrates adjacent tissue**

Examples may include:

- * implant erosion
- * mesh erosion
- * lead/device erosion

Meaning:

> the device gradually wears through or becomes exposed through tissue.

Specialist medical use.

L. COMPUTER SCIENCE / IMAGE PROCESSING

44. **morphological erosion = mathematical morphology operation (影像處理) — 形態學侵蝕**

This is a genuinely distinct technical meaning.

In binary/grayscale image processing, **erosion** is an operation that typically:

- * shrinks foreground regions;
- * removes pixels near boundaries;
- * eliminates small structures;
- * depends on a chosen structuring element.

It is often paired with:

> **dilation**

= 膨脹.

45. **erode an image/mask (電腦視覺) — 對影像 / 遮罩作侵蝕運算**

Example

> “Erode the binary mask by two pixels.”

「對二值遮罩進行兩個像素的**侵蝕運算**。」

Here **erode** is a technical verb, not metaphorical geology.

46. **erosion followed by dilation = opening (形態學)**

A standard mathematical-morphology operation:

> erosion → dilation

is used in morphological **opening** under standard definitions.

Similarly:

> dilation → erosion

gives **closing**.

These are domain constructions rather than new meanings of **erode**.

M. SOFTWARE ENGINEERING

47. **software architecture erosion / architectural erosion (軟件工程) — 架構侵蝕**

A software system’s implemented structure may gradually diverge from its intended architecture as:

- * shortcuts accumulate;
- * dependencies proliferate;
- * design constraints are violated.

This is often called:

> architecture erosion / architectural erosion.

It is a technical metaphor derived from gradual physical wearing away.

48. **software quality erosion = gradual degradation (軟件) **

More broadly:

- > maintainability erosion
- > design erosion
- > quality erosion

may describe gradual deterioration of software quality.

These remain figurative technical uses.

N. **EROSION** IN SOCIAL / ORGANIZATIONAL ANALYSIS

49. **erosion of trust = 信任侵蝕**

Probably the most common abstract **erosion of X** construction.

50. **erosion of standards = 標準逐漸下降**

> “There was concern about the erosion of professional standards.”

「有人憂慮專業標準逐漸**被削弱**。」

51. **erosion of privacy = 私隱逐步受侵蝕**

Meaning:

> protections/boundaries around privacy become progressively weaker.

52. **erosion of competitive advantage = 競爭優勢逐步減弱**

Business strategy use.

53. **erosion of customer loyalty = 顧客忠誠度下降**

A straightforward commercial metaphor.

54. **erosion of boundaries/distinctions (抽象) — 界線逐漸模糊 / 消失**

Example:

> “Technology has contributed to the erosion of the boundary between work and home.”

「科技令工作與家庭之間的界線逐漸**模糊 / 消失**。」

Here the thing “worn away” is conceptual separation.

O. **EROSIVE**

55. **erosive = causing physical erosion (侵蝕性的) **

Practice 17

> “Strong currents have an **erosive** effect on the riverbank.”

「強勁水流對河岸有**侵蝕作用**。」

Common:

* erosive force

* erosive action

* erosive process

* erosive agent

56. **erosive = gradually damaging something abstract (比喻) — 具有侵蝕作用的**

> “Persistent mistrust can have an erosive effect on teamwork.”

「長期的不信任會對團隊合作產生**侵蝕性影響**。」

Formal.

57. **erosive** — medical/dental

Examples:

- * erosive gastritis
- * erosive esophagitis
- * erosive arthritis
- * erosive tooth wear

Here **erosive** relates to tissue/material erosion.

P. **EROSIONAL**

58. **erosional** = relating to erosion as a geological process (地質) — 侵蝕作用的；侵蝕形成的

Common:

- * erosional landform
- * erosional feature
- * erosional process
- * erosional surface

Practice 18

> “The valley contains several erosional features.”

「這個山谷包含多種**侵蝕地貌特徵**。」

Generally more technical/geological than **erosive**.

Important distinction: **erosive** vs **erosional**

erosive

often means:

> actively causing erosion.

> erosive force

erosional

usually means:

> relating to erosion or produced by erosion.

> erosional landform

There is overlap, but the tendencies differ.

Q. **ERODIBLE**

59. **erodible** = capable of being eroded (可侵蝕的 ; 易被侵蝕的) **

Practice 19

> “Loose soil is highly **erodible**.”

「鬆散土壤非常**容易被侵蝕**。」

Common in:

* soil science

* environmental engineering

* geomorphology

R. **ERODIBILITY**

60. **erodibility** = susceptibility of material/soil to erosion (可蝕性 ; 抗蝕能力的反面) **

Erodibility describes how readily a material—especially soil—is eroded.

Practice 20

> “Soil texture strongly affects **erodibility**.”

「土壤質地會大大影響其**可蝕性**。」

Important distinction:

> **erodibility** describes the material's vulnerability.

S. ****EROSIVITY****

61. ****erosivity = ability of an agent to cause erosion (侵蝕力) ****

Especially:

> rainfall erosivity

= rainfall's capacity to cause soil erosion.

So:

****erodibility****

= 土壤 / 材料有多容易被侵蝕

****erosivity****

= 雨、水流等有多強的侵蝕能力

This distinction is important in soil/environmental science.

T. ****EROSION CONTROL ****

62. ****erosion control = measures used to prevent/reduce erosion (防蝕 / 侵蝕控制) ****

Examples:

- * vegetation
- * retaining structures
- * erosion-control mats
- * terraces
- * drainage management

Common:

- > erosion-control measures
- > erosion-control blanket
- > erosion-control barrier

63. **erosion-resistant = resistant to erosion (抗侵蝕的) **

Used for:

- * materials
- * coatings
- * landscapes
- * engineering surfaces

U. IMPORTANT COLLOCATION PATTERNS

erode + physical object

- * erode soil
- * erode rock
- * erode a coastline
- * erode a surface
- * erode enamel

erode + abstract noun

- * erode trust
- * erode confidence
- * erode support
- * erode value
- * erode purchasing power
- * erode profits
- * erode margins
- * erode credibility
- * erode authority
- * erode standards
- * erode courtesy

be eroded by

> “The coast is eroded by waves.”

> “Profit margins were eroded by rising costs.”

Same grammar, literal or figurative.

erosion of + noun

- * erosion of soil
- * erosion of the coastline
- * erosion of trust
- * erosion of value
- * erosion of standards
- * erosion of market share

Very productive construction.

V. IMPORTANT DISTINCTIONS

erode vs destroy

destroy

can happen suddenly and completely.

erode

normally suggests gradual weakening or removal.

> “The explosion destroyed the building.”

versus:

> “Years of neglect eroded the structure.”

erode vs damage

damage

is broad.

erode

suggests incremental loss over time.

> one accident damaged confidence

possible but figurative.

> repeated failures eroded confidence

strongly emphasizes gradual decline.

erode vs weaken

weaken

simply means make less strong.

erode

adds imagery of gradual wearing away.

> weaken support

> erode support

Erode sounds more incremental and cumulative.

erode vs undermine

undermine

means weaken the foundation/effectiveness of something, sometimes deliberately.

erode

emphasizes gradual loss.

> secrecy undermined trust

may mean it damaged the basis of trust.

> repeated secrecy eroded trust

emphasizes progressive decline.

erode vs chip away at

chip away at

is an informal/metaphorical expression for gradually reducing something.

> chip away at confidence

Very similar imagery, but **erode** is more formal.

erode vs deteriorate

deteriorate

usually intransitive:

> conditions deteriorated.

erode

can be transitive:

> rising costs eroded profits.

So:

> "Trust deteriorated."

versus:

> "Repeated dishonesty eroded trust."

erode vs decay

decay

often describes deterioration through decomposition/neglect/time.

erode

specifically suggests material or strength being gradually worn away.

> tooth decay
> tooth erosion

are medically/dentally different.

erode vs wear away

wear away

is everyday and often physical.

erode

is more technical/formal and also highly productive figuratively.

> water wore away the stone
> water eroded the stone

Both possible.

erosion vs abrasion

erosion

broad progressive material loss.

abrasion

surface wear specifically through rubbing/friction.

Abrasion can contribute to erosion.

erosion vs corrosion

erosion

mechanical/physical removal.

corrosion

chemical/electrochemical degradation.

But combined:

> erosion-corrosion.

****erosion vs ulcer — medicine****

****erosion****

typically relatively superficial tissue loss.

****ulcer****

generally extends deeper into tissue.

Exact clinical definitions depend on anatomical site and specialty.

W. GRAMMAR

64. ****erode is both transitive and intransitive****

Transitive

> “The current eroded the bank.”

Intransitive

> “The bank gradually eroded.”

Both standard.

65. ****be eroded by****

> “Public confidence was eroded by repeated failures.”

A very common passive construction.

66. **erode from / erode into?**

These are much less central than:

- * erode something
- * erode away
- * be eroded by

Do not mechanically add prepositions.

X. COUNTABILITY

erosion — process

Usually uncountable:

- > coastal erosion
- > soil erosion
- > erosion of trust

an erosion

Possible when referring to:

- * a specific medical lesion;
- * an instance/area of superficial tissue loss.

Example:

> “The examination revealed several gastric erosions.”

「檢查發現數處胃黏膜**糜爛**。」

So medical **erosion** can readily be countable.

Y. FAMILY MAP

Family form	Main modern use	
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erode	physically wear away; figuratively weaken gradually	
eroded	worn away / gradually weakened	
eroding	undergoing or causing gradual loss	
erosion	physical/figurative/medical/technical wearing away	
erosive	causing erosion; medically involving erosions	
erosional	relating to or produced by geological erosion	
erodible	capable of being eroded	
erodibility	susceptibility of a material/soil to erosion	
erosivity	ability of an agent such as rainfall to cause erosion	

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning	
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erode — geology	水、風、冰等逐漸磨走並帶走岩石 / 土壤；侵蝕	
erode — material surface	因流體、粒子、摩擦等逐漸磨損表面	
erode — abstract	長期逐步削弱信任、價值、標準、支持等	
erode — financial	逐步降低價值、購買力、利潤、利潤率等	
erode — medical/dental	使表面組織 / 牙體物質出現逐步缺損	
soil erosion	表層土壤被水 / 風等移走的土壤侵蝕	
coastal erosion	海浪、水流等造成的岸線 / 海岸侵蝕	
erosion wear	粒子、液滴或流體造成的機械磨蝕	
cavitation erosion	氣泡形成與崩潰造成的空蝕 / 氣蝕	
erosion-corrosion	機械沖蝕與化學 / 電化學腐蝕共同造成的損害	
erosion of trust	信任逐步被削弱	
price erosion	商品 / 服務價格逐漸下降	
margin erosion	利潤率逐步下降 / 被壓縮	
tax-base erosion	可課稅基礎逐步縮小；稅基侵蝕	
skin/mucosal erosion	表層上皮組織缺損 / 糜爛	
dental erosion	非細菌性酸等造成的牙體物質化學流失 / 酸蝕	
bone erosion	局部骨質被破壞 / 侵蝕	
morphological erosion	影像處理中使前景區域縮小的形態學侵蝕運算	
architectural erosion	軟件實作逐漸偏離原設計架構的架構侵蝕	
erosive	能造成侵蝕 / 逐步損害的	
erosional	與侵蝕過程有關或由侵蝕形成的	
erodible	容易 / 可以被侵蝕的	
erodibility	材料 / 土壤本身被侵蝕的容易程度	
erosivity	雨、水流等侵蝕作用來源造成侵蝕的能力	

For your original sentence

> “...behaviour that **erodes everyday courtesy**.”

The exact meaning is:

**erodes = 某種自私 / 不顧及他人的行為如果持續被視為正常，就會一點一點削弱人們日常互相

體諒和保持禮貌的習慣**

So:

> **erode everyday courtesy**

= **逐漸侵蝕日常禮貌 / 慢慢削弱人與人之間的體諒**

The verb is especially effective because it implies:

> courtesy does not disappear in one dramatic moment;

> it is **worn away little by little**.

For your database, I would keep **4 major semantic cores** while explicitly indexing all of the domain branches above:

1. **physically wear away/remove soil, rock, surfaces, or material**
2. **figuratively weaken or diminish something gradually**
3. **medical/dental superficial tissue or material loss**
4. **technical mathematical/image-processing erosion**

Then engineering erosion, financial erosion, software-architecture erosion, soil/coastal subtypes, and the full **erosive / erosional / erodible / erodibility / erosivity** family should remain separately searchable rather than being collapsed out of view.